

every real estate agent told me, if I wanted three bedrooms plus a den in that vicinity, I'd have to pay over a million dollars. My intention was to keep my investment in this home under a million. Most people would either lower their expectations or raise their budget. I held out for both. I recently got a call that the owners of a house in the exact location I wanted, with the number of rooms I wanted, had reduced their price \$200,000 to under a million. Here is another tribute to the intention of having both!

Finally, I always told my parents that I didn't want to slave away at work I didn't enjoy and that I would "get rich doing what I love." Their response was the usual: "You're living in a dream world. Life is not a bowl of cherries." They said, "Business is business, pleasure is pleasure. First you take care of making a living, then, if there's any time left over, you can enjoy your life."

I remember thinking to myself, "Hmm, if I listen to them, I'll end up like them. No. I'm gonna have *both*!" Was it tough? You bet. Sometimes I'd have to work at a job I hated for a week or two so I could eat and pay the rent. But I never lost my intention of having "both." I never got stuck long-term in a job or business I didn't like. Eventually I did become rich doing what I loved. Now that I know it can be done, I continue to pursue only the work and projects that I love. Best of all, I now have the privilege of teaching others to do the same.

Nowhere is "both" thinking more important than when it comes to money. Poor and many middle-class people believe that they have to choose between money and the other aspects of life. Consequently they've rationalized a position that money is not as important as other things.

Let's set the record straight. Money is important! To say that it's not as important as any of the other things in life is ludicrous. What's more important, your arm or your leg? Could it be that *both* are important?

Money is a lubricant. It enables you to "slide" through life instead of having to "scrape" by. Money brings freedom—freedom to buy what you want, and freedom to do what you want with your time. Money allows you to enjoy the finer things in life as well as giving you the opportunity to help others have the necessities in life. Most of all, having money allows you not to have to spend your energy worrying about not having money.

Happiness is important too. Again, here's where poor and middle-class people get confused. Many believe money and happiness are